

# Live Arena: An Open-Source, Contract-First Architecture for Scalable Hyper-Local Sports Matchmaking, Real-Time Streaming, and Deterministic Roster Governance

Muhammad Maaz

Department of Computer Science

University of Engineering and Technology (UET) Peshawar  
Peshawar, Pakistan

muhammadmaaz.dev@gmail.com

Dr. Zakira Inayat

Department of Computer Science

University of Engineering and Technology (UET) Peshawar  
Peshawar, Pakistan

zakirainayat@uetpeshawar.edu.pk

**Abstract**—Grassroots amateur athletics—spanning casual football, street cricket, amateur basketball, and badminton—serve as essential catalysts for physical health and urban social cohesion. However, organizing informal pickup games is severely hindered by three socio-technical bottlenecks: prohibitive recurring commercial mapping fees, unconstrained roster dropouts causing match forfeitures, and client-server schema drift in decoupled web architectures. This paper presents Live Arena, an open-source, contract-first system engineered for scalable hyper-local event discovery, real-time matchmaking, and automated roster governance. Live Arena introduces: (1) a dual-stage geospatial retrieval pipeline combining Cartesian bounding-box B-Tree pre-filtering with exact Haversine great-circle verification over OpenStreetMap, reducing spatial query complexity from  $O(V)$  to  $O(\log V + k)$  without commercial API costs; (2) a discrete capacity-constrained FIFO waitlist state machine mathematically modeled under Little’s Law, providing provable overbooking invariance ( $P(|A| > C) = 0$ ) under high concurrent contention; (3) a contract-first pipeline enforcing build-time type generation and runtime Zod validation from an OpenAPI 3.1 specification; and (4) a stateful WebSocket engine (`SocketHub`) delivering full-duplex match and direct chat streaming. We conduct extensive benchmarking across  $N = 10,000$  synthetic athlete profiles,  $M = 2,500$  sports fixtures, and up to 1,000 concurrent WebSocket connections. Compared against naive trigonometric full-scan and HTTP short-polling baselines, Live Arena achieves an  $8.8\times$  geospatial query speedup ( $28.4 \pm 2.1$  ms vs.  $251.2 \pm 14.6$  ms), a  $6.8\times$  reduction in broadcast latency ( $14.6 \pm 1.8$  ms vs.  $98.7 \pm 8.2$  ms), 340 req/s peak transactional throughput, and 100% Sybil review rejection via attendance-gated cryptographic verification. The platform is fully open-sourced under the MIT license with complete reproducibility artifacts.

**Index Terms**—Event-Based Social Networks (EBSNs), Contract-First Architecture, Geospatial Indexing, Real-Time WebSockets, Concurrency Control, State Machines, Software Engineering.

## I. INTRODUCTION

Recreational grassroots sports—such as weekend pickup football, street cricket, community basketball, and casual badminton—represent a fundamental pillar of public health, mental well-being, and municipal social capital. Unlike professional athletic leagues backed by administrative staff and reserved

private facilities, grassroots sports rely almost exclusively on informal, decentralized volunteer coordination.

However, organizing pickup matches remains plagued by persistent operational friction across three distinct technological dimensions:

- 1) **Commercial API Lock-In and Spatial Inefficiency:** Contemporary discovery platforms rely on proprietary mapping APIs (e.g., Google Places at \$7.00 per 1,000 requests), imposing unsustainable operational costs on non-profit community organizers. Commercial court aggregators (e.g., Playo) restrict discovery to monetized partner venues, neglecting open public parks and school grounds. Furthermore, evaluating geodesic distances across unindexed spatial tables incurs severe computational overhead.
- 2) **Roster Dropouts and Unconstrained Coordination:** General social media networks (e.g., Facebook Events) utilize ambiguous RSVP categories (“Interested” vs. “Going”), resulting in attendance dropout rates often exceeding 40%. When a confirmed player cancels hours before kickoff, organizers face a frantic scramble across fragmented chat channels to find replacements. Without capacity-constrained, automated waitlist promotion, matches frequently collapse due to missing players.
- 3) **Interface Drift and Radio Power Waste:** Decoupled web applications separating Single-Page Applications (SPAs) from REST backends frequently suffer from *schema drift* when database modifications fail to synchronize with client types, causing silent runtime deserialization crashes. Furthermore, relying on HTTP short-polling for match updates floods mobile radio networks with redundant header overhead, wasting over 80% of bandwidth and introducing multi-second communication delays.

To overcome these structural limitations, this paper presents **Live Arena**, a comprehensive, contract-first open-source archi-

texture for zero-cost hyper-local sports event discovery, real-time matchmaking, and automated roster governance.

#### A. Formal Research Questions

This investigation is guided by five primary research questions ( $RQ_1$ – $RQ_5$ ):

- **$RQ_1$  (Contract Conformance & Zero Drift):** How effectively does an end-to-end contract-first pipeline (OpenAPI 3.1 + Zod + Orval) eliminate runtime serialization defects across decoupled client-server boundaries compared to code-first REST implementations?
- **$RQ_2$  (Geospatial Retrieval Efficiency):** Can a dual-stage Cartesian B-Tree pre-filter paired with Haversine verification over OpenStreetMap achieve sub-30 ms query latencies at scale ( $M = 2,500$  fixtures) while eliminating commercial mapping fees?
- **$RQ_3$  (Deterministic Concurrency & Roster Invariance):** How does an automated FIFO waitlist state machine maintain capacity constraints without race conditions or double-booking anomalies under concurrent registration surges?
- **$RQ_4$  (Real-Time Streaming vs. Polling Overhead):** What quantitative latency, throughput, and packet-framing improvements are achieved by deploying a native WebSocket room-multiplexing hub over HTTP short-polling under increasing concurrent connections (50 to 1,000 sockets)?
- **$RQ_5$  (Reputation Governance & Sybil Resistance):** To what extent does an attendance-gated cryptographic verification barrier eliminate fraudulent review inflation and organizer manipulation compared to open social review baselines?

#### B. Key Contributions

The main contributions of this work are summarized as follows:

- **Contract-First Architecture:** We formalize an end-to-end workflow utilizing OpenAPI 3.1 as an immutable single source of truth, establishing build-time TypeScript generation and runtime Zod validation to achieve verifiable zero-drift execution.
- **Dual-Stage Geospatial Search Algorithm:** We formulate and analyze a two-tier spatial retrieval algorithm combining Cartesian bounding-box B-Tree range constraints with exact Haversine spherical verification, reducing complexity from  $O(V)$  to  $O(\log V + k)$  with zero recurring commercial API expenditure.
- **Deterministic Waitlist State Machine & Invariant Proofs:** We mathematically formalize event attendance as a capacity-constrained discrete state machine adhering to Little’s Law. We provide formal mathematical proofs of Theorem 1 (Overbooking Invariance:  $P(|A| > C) = 0$ ) and Theorem 2 (Starvation-Free FIFO Promotion) under PostgreSQL row-level pessimistic locking.
- **Full-Duplex SocketHub Multiplexing Engine:** We design a stateful WebSocket engine managing isolated room

multiplexing for match pitches and direct athlete chats, achieving sub-15 ms broadcast delays and a  $6.8\times$  latency reduction over HTTP polling.

- **Comprehensive Empirical Benchmarking & Security Analysis:** We conduct extensive benchmarks across  $N = 10,000$  user profiles,  $M = 2,500$  fixtures, and up to 1,000 concurrent WebSocket connections. We evaluate review spam resistance under 500 injected Sybil attacks (100% detection rate) and present a dedicated privacy framework incorporating spatial coordinate cloaking.
- **Open-Source Artifact Package:** We release the complete platform under the MIT license, including Docker Compose orchestration, OpenAPI schemas, synthetic trace generators, and test suites.

## II. RELATED WORK & PROBLEM FORMULATION

### A. Event-Based Social Networks (EBSNs) and Matchmaking

Event-Based Social Networks (EBSNs) bridge digital online interactions with physical-world offline gatherings [1], [2]. Foundational studies by Liu *et al.* [1] and Tian *et al.* [2] demonstrated that physical event participation exhibits severe spatial decay: participant likelihood drops exponentially with geographic distance. Pham *et al.* [3] proposed spatial-temporal influence models for event participation, while Farkas *et al.* [4] analyzed dynamic roster balancing in recreational networks. However, earlier EBSN research primarily focused on offline trace analysis, recommendation models, or theoretical matchmaking, offering limited architectural solutions for real-time operational roster synchronization.

Commercial platforms have largely failed to address grassroots athletic needs. Meetup [5] enforces organizer subscriptions (\$16–\$24/month) that deter casual pickup organizers. Playo focuses on commercial court booking commissions, restricting discovery to monetized partner facilities. SportEasy and TeamSnap support pre-formed teams with static rosters, but lack dynamic hyper-local discovery for unaffiliated individual athletes. Table I presents an eight-dimension comparative analysis positioning Live Arena against state-of-the-art platforms.

### B. Design by Contract and Interface Drift in Web Stacks

The evolution of modern web applications toward decoupled architectures—separating React/TypeScript SPAs from Node.js microservices—has introduced subtle boundary failure modes. Code-first REST development models, where endpoints and types are implemented ad-hoc, inevitably suffer from *schema drift* as database migrations or API endpoints evolve without corresponding frontend type updates. Meyer’s [6] Design by Contract (DbC) principle asserts that software reliability hinges on strict, enforceable preconditions, postconditions, and invariants. While GraphQL attempts to enforce schema typing, it introduces substantial runtime parsing overhead, query complexity vulnerabilities, and complex caching semantics. Recent work by Vukotić *et al.* [7] highlights the necessity of automated schema conformance. Live Arena applies DbC principles via an OpenAPI 3.1 single source of truth, enforcing

TABLE I  
STATE-OF-THE-ART COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS ACROSS EIGHT OPERATIONAL CAPABILITIES

| Operational Feature  | Meetup [5]      | Playo (2024)      | Facebook Events   | SportEasy (2024) | Academic EBSNs [2] | Live Arena (Proposed)          |
|----------------------|-----------------|-------------------|-------------------|------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------|
| Primary Domain       | General Events  | Commercial Courts | Social Feed       | Team Rosters     | Theoretical Model  | <b>Grassroots Sports</b>       |
| Geospatial Discovery | Commercial API  | Proprietary Venue | Commercial API    | Address Text     | Simulated Traces   | <b>OSM + Haversine B-Tree</b>  |
| Waitlist Allocation  | Manual / Static | Venue-Dependent   | None (Unbounded)  | Static List      | Unconstrained      | <b>Deterministic FIFO</b>      |
| Real-Time Messaging  | Async Forum     | In-App Messaging  | Comment Stream    | Threaded Forum   | None (Offline)     | <b>Native WebSockets</b>       |
| Type Drift Safety    | None            | Closed Source     | None              | Closed Source    | None               | <b>OpenAPI 3.1 + Zod</b>       |
| Recurring Cost       | \$16-\$24 / mo  | Commission / Fee  | Free (Ad-Driven)  | Freemium Tier    | N/A                | <b>Cost-Free (Open)</b>        |
| Review Integrity     | Open            | Venue Only        | Open / Unverified | None             | None               | <b>Attendance-Gated</b>        |
| Source Availability  | Closed          | Closed            | Closed            | Closed           | Open Traces        | <b>Fully Open-Source (MIT)</b> |

static type propagation at build time and strict Zod validation at runtime.

### III. THEORETICAL FORMULATIONS & ALGORITHMIC FOUNDATIONS

#### A. Geodesic Proximity & Bounding Box Optimization

Finding nearby sports events within an athlete's search radius  $r$  requires evaluating geodesic distances over the Earth's curved surface [8], [9]. Executing trigonometric distance functions across every venue in a spatial database incurs prohibitive  $O(V)$  CPU overhead. Live Arena resolves this using a dual-stage spatial retrieval algorithm:

1) *Stage 1: Cartesian Bounding Box Pre-Filter*: Given athlete coordinates  $(\phi_0, \lambda_0)$  in radians and search radius  $r$  in kilometers, the bounding coordinate offsets are derived from Earth's mean radius  $R = 6,371$  km:

$$\Delta\phi = \frac{r}{R}, \quad \Delta\lambda = \frac{r}{R \cos(\phi_0)} \quad (1)$$

The database filter is formalized as a conjunction of linear range constraints:

$$\phi \in [\phi_0 - \Delta\phi, \phi_0 + \Delta\phi] \quad (2)$$

$$\lambda \in [\lambda_0 - \Delta\lambda, \lambda_0 + \Delta\lambda] \quad (3)$$

Because  $\phi$  and  $\lambda$  are indexed using standard B-Tree indexes in PostgreSQL, this filter executes in  $O(\log V + k)$  time, pruning  $> 90\%$  of non-qualifying fixtures prior to trigonometric evaluation.

2) *Stage 2: Exact Great-Circle Haversine Verification*: For candidates passing the bounding box stage, the exact spherical angular separation  $\Delta\sigma$  and geodesic distance  $d$  are computed via the Haversine formula [8]:

$$\Delta\sigma = 2 \arcsin \left( \sqrt{\sin^2 \left( \frac{\Delta\phi}{2} \right) + \cos(\phi_0) \cos(\phi) \sin^2 \left( \frac{\Delta\lambda}{2} \right)} \right) \quad (4)$$

$$d = R \cdot \Delta\sigma \quad (5)$$

A candidate fixture is admitted into the result set if and only if  $d \leq r$ .

#### B. Deterministic FIFO Waitlist State Machine & Queueing Theoretic Modeling

Match fixtures enforce a discrete capacity constraint  $C \in \mathbb{N}^+$ . The state  $S$  of a fixture's participant registry is partitioned into two mutually exclusive sets:

- **Confirmed Attendees ( $A$ )**:  $A = \{u_1, u_2, \dots, u_k\}$ , where  $|A| \leq C$ .
- **Ordered Waitlist Queue ( $W$ )**:  $W = \langle w_1, w_2, \dots, w_m \rangle$ .

State transitions are governed by an atomic transition function  $\delta(S, e) \rightarrow S'$ :

1) **Join Request ( $e_{\text{join}}(u)$ )**:

$$\delta(S, e_{\text{join}}(u)) = \begin{cases} (A \cup \{u\}, W), & \text{if } |A| < C \\ (A, W \cdot \langle u \rangle), & \text{if } |A| = C \end{cases} \quad (6)$$

2) **Dropout / Cancellation ( $e_{\text{leave}}(u_i)$  where  $u_i \in A$ )**:

$$\delta(S, e_{\text{leave}}(u_i)) = \begin{cases} ((A \setminus \{u_i\}) \cup \{w_1\}, \text{tail}(W)), & \text{if } |W| > 0 \\ (A \setminus \{u_i\}, \emptyset), & \text{if } |W| = 0 \end{cases} \quad (7)$$

3) **Waitlist Timeout ( $e_{\text{timeout}}(w_1)$ )**: If a promoted waitlist participant fails to confirm within threshold  $\tau_{\text{confirm}}$ , the token is revoked and offered to head( $\text{tail}(W)$ ).

1) *Queueing Theoretic Modeling via Little's Law*: By Little's Law [10], the average number of waitlisted athletes  $L_W$  under stationary arrival rate  $\lambda_W$  and average wait time  $W_W$  satisfies:

$$L_W = \lambda_W \cdot W_W \quad (8)$$

When player cancellations occur as a Poisson process with rate  $\mu_{\text{cancel}}$ , the expected promotion waiting time for an athlete at queue position  $k$  is given by  $E[W_k] = k / \mu_{\text{cancel}}$ .

#### C. Concurrency Control and Invariant Proofs

To prevent race conditions during concurrent registration surges, all state transitions execute within an atomic PostgreSQL transaction under REPEATABLE READ isolation with row-level pessimistic locking:

```
SELECT * FROM events WHERE id = $1 FOR UPDATE;
```

(9)

In addition, a composite unique database constraint `UNIQUE(event_id, user_id)` guarantees idempotency.

**Theorem 1** (Overbooking Invariance). *Under atomic execution of transition function  $\delta(S, e)$  with pessimistic row-level locking,*

the confirmed attendee set  $A$  strictly satisfies the capacity invariant  $|A| \leq C$  for all possible execution interleavings.

*Proof.* By induction on the sequence of operations  $\tau = \langle e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n \rangle$ . *Base Case:* Initially,  $S_0 = (\emptyset, \emptyset)$ , so  $|A_0| = 0 \leq C$ . *Inductive Step:* Assume  $|A_t| \leq C$  holds at step  $t$ . At step  $t + 1$ , an event  $e_{t+1}$  occurs:

- If  $e_{t+1} = e_{\text{join}}(u)$ : If  $|A_t| < C$ , then  $|A_{t+1}| = |A_t| + 1 \leq C$ . If  $|A_t| = C$ , the condition  $|A_t| < C$  evaluates to false; user  $u$  is appended to  $W$  and  $A_{t+1} = A_t$ , maintaining  $|A_{t+1}| = C \leq C$ .
- If  $e_{t+1} = e_{\text{leave}}(u_i)$ : If  $|W_t| > 0$ , one user is removed and one is added from  $W$ , yielding  $|A_{t+1}| = |A_t| - 1 + 1 = |A_t| \leq C$ . If  $|W_t| = 0$ ,  $|A_{t+1}| = |A_t| - 1 < C$ .

Because each transaction acquires an exclusive row lock on the event entity before reading or writing  $A$ , transitions are strictly serialized. Hence,  $P(|A| > C) = 0$  for all traces  $\tau$ .  $\square$

**Theorem 2** (Starvation-Free FIFO Promotion). *Given a non-empty waitlist queue  $W = \langle w_1, w_2, \dots, w_m \rangle$ , upon any leave event  $e_{\text{leave}}$ , the user promoted to confirmed attendee status is uniquely and deterministically the head of the queue  $w_1$ , ensuring starvation freedom.*

*Proof.* Follows directly from Eq. (7), where the promoted participant is defined as  $w_1 = \text{head}(W)$ , and the new waitlist queue becomes  $\text{tail}(W)$ , preserving strict chronological FIFO arrival order.  $\square$

## IV. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE & IMPLEMENTATION

### A. Architectural Blueprint

Live Arena is structured as a decoupled, multi-tier reactive system:

- 1) **Presentation Tier:** Built with React 19, TypeScript, and Vite. Utilizes TailwindCSS and Lucide-React for styling, and Leaflet with OpenStreetMap tiles for zero-cost map visualization.
- 2) **Client Data Synchronization Tier:** TanStack Query (React Query) handles caching, deduplication, and optimistic cache mutations.
- 3) **Application and Real-Time Streaming Tier:** Powered by Node.js 24 and Express 5. Contains SocketHub, a stateful native WebSocket engine managing isolated room multiplexing for match pitches (`event: {id}`) and direct 1-on-1 athlete channels (`direct: {u1}: {u2}`).
- 4) **Persistence Tier:** PostgreSQL 16 managed through Drizzle ORM. Enforces Third Normal Form (3NF) relational integrity across Users, Events, Event Participants, Messages, Reviews, and Reports with foreign key cascading and atomic constraints.

### B. Contract-First Zero-Drift Pipeline

To eliminate client-server schema drift:

- 1) An OpenAPI 3.1 specification (`openapi.yaml`) defines all data models, path parameters, and response bodies as the immutable single source of truth.

- 2) Spectral linters enforce OpenAPI syntax correctness during continuous integration.
- 3) Orval compiles the contract directly into typed TypeScript interfaces and TanStack Query client hooks.
- 4) Zod schemas parse and validate incoming HTTP request payloads at runtime on the Express API boundary, guaranteeing that malformed data is rejected before database execution.

## V. EXPERIMENTAL EVALUATION & EMPIRICAL RESULTS

### A. Experimental Testbed Setup

Benchmarking was conducted on a dedicated host running AMD Ryzen 7 (8 physical cores, 16 threads @ 3.8 GHz), 16 GB DDR4 RAM, and 512 GB NVMe SSD running Ubuntu 22.04 LTS, Node.js 24.2.0, Express 5.0.1, and PostgreSQL 16.2.

To ensure realistic evaluation scale, the ground truth corpus comprised  $N = 10,000$  synthetic athlete profiles and  $M = 2,500$  sports fixtures distributed across five municipal districts in Peshawar, Pakistan (Hayatabad Sports Complex, Islamia College Ground, Peshawar Sports Complex, Shahi Bagh Arena, Peshawar Club Ground) mapped via OpenStreetMap coordinates.

### B. Baseline Definitions

To evaluate performance quantitatively, Live Arena is compared against two standardized industry baselines:

- **Baseline A (Unindexed Spatial Scan + Short Polling):** Evaluates Haversine distance via sequential table scan across all  $M$  records without Cartesian pre-filtering, paired with standard 2.0-second HTTP client short-polling.
- **Baseline B (In-Memory Application Filtering + Long Polling):** Fetches unfiltered spatial candidates into Node.js application memory for JavaScript-based distance calculation, paired with HTTP long-polling.
- **Live Arena (Proposed):** Employs dual-stage Cartesian B-Tree pre-filtering with exact database Haversine verification and native SocketHub WebSocket room multiplexing.

### C. Empirical Benchmark Findings

Table II summarizes the quantitative performance benchmarks across  $K = 50$  repeated experimental runs.

TABLE II  
EMPIRICAL PERFORMANCE BENCHMARKS ACROSS CORE OPERATIONS  
( $K = 50$  ITERATIONS, MEAN  $\pm$  STANDARD DEVIATION)

| Workload Metric                 | Baseline A          | Baseline B          | Live Arena                           | Speedup                        |
|---------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Geospatial Query ( $r = 10$ km) | $251.2 \pm 14.6$ ms | $112.4 \pm 8.2$ ms  | <b><math>28.4 \pm 2.1</math> ms</b>  | <b><math>8.8\times</math></b>  |
| One-Click Event Join            | $182.5 \pm 11.3$ ms | $88.2 \pm 6.4$ ms   | <b><math>19.1 \pm 1.4</math> ms</b>  | <b><math>9.6\times</math></b>  |
| Waitlist Promotion              | $498.2 \pm 22.1$ ms | $184.6 \pm 12.3$ ms | <b><math>43.2 \pm 3.2</math> ms</b>  | <b><math>11.5\times</math></b> |
| Broadcast Delay (500 sockets)   | $98.7 \pm 8.2$ ms   | $64.1 \pm 5.5$ ms   | <b><math>14.6 \pm 1.8</math> ms</b>  | <b><math>6.8\times</math></b>  |
| Typing Indicator Latency        | $76.4 \pm 6.1$ ms   | $48.2 \pm 4.0$ ms   | <b><math>10.2 \pm 1.1</math> ms</b>  | <b><math>7.5\times</math></b>  |
| Peak Throughput                 | $98 \pm 6$ req/s    | $165 \pm 12$ req/s  | <b><math>340 \pm 15</math> req/s</b> | <b><math>3.5\times</math></b>  |

As reported in Table II, Live Arena achieves an  $8.8\times$  speedup in geospatial querying (28.4 ms vs. 251.2 ms,  $p < 0.001$ ) and a  $6.8\times$  reduction in real-time broadcast delay over Baseline A.

#### D. Concurrent WebSocket Stress Testing

To evaluate real-time scalability under increasing load, SocketHub was stress-tested using an automated k6 WebSocket harness scaling from 50 to 1,000 concurrent active socket connections. As illustrated in the benchmarking logs, at 1,000 concurrent clients, P50 broadcast latency remained at 14.8 ms, P95 at 22.4 ms, and P99 at 31.2 ms with zero dropped frames and < 110 MB Node.js process memory footprint.

#### E. Automated Concurrency Stress Testing

Under concurrency stress testing with 500 simultaneous join requests directed at a 10-person capacity match, exactly 10 slots were allocated to confirmed attendees and 490 users were deterministically placed on the FIFO waitlist in strict arrival order with zero race conditions, zero duplicate tickets, and zero overbooking anomalies ( $|A| = 10 \leq 10$ ).

#### F. Empirical Evaluation of RQ5: Reputation Governance & Sybil Resistance

To empirically answer  $RQ_5$ , an adversarial stress test was conducted injecting 500 simulated spam review submissions against completed match events:

- 200 reviews from non-registered users.
- 150 reviews from waitlisted users who never received confirmed promotion.
- 150 reviews from users who joined but cancelled prior to match commencement.

TABLE III  
EMPIRICAL GOVERNANCE EVALUATION UNDER SYBIL REVIEW INJECTION  
ATTACK ( $N = 500$  INJECTED ATTACKS)

| Governance Model                | Spam Rejection   | False Positives | Check Overhead |
|---------------------------------|------------------|-----------------|----------------|
| Open Review System (Baseline)   | 0.0% (0/500)     | 0.0%            | 0.05 ms        |
| Heuristic IP/Account Age Filter | 34.2% (171/500)  | 8.4%            | 4.20 ms        |
| Live Arena (Attendance-Gated)   | 100.0% (500/500) | 0.0%            | 1.14 ms        |

Table III demonstrates that Live Arena’s attendance-gated cryptographic verification successfully rejected 100% of fraudulent review injections with 0% false positives and an overhead of only 1.14 ms per transaction, validating  $RQ_5$ .

## VI. SECURITY, PRIVACY, AND ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

#### A. Geospatial Privacy & Coordinate Obfuscation

Publicizing exact geographic coordinates for private pickup games or residential matches introduces potential stalking and privacy risks. Live Arena enforces an  $\epsilon$ -differential privacy spatial cloaking protocol [11]: for matches marked as private, exact venue coordinates are rounded to the nearest 150 m street-grid centroid for unconfirmed browsing athletes. Exact venue pin coordinates and specific entrance details are revealed only to confirmed attendees whose tickets have been authenticated.

#### B. Authentication, Session Security, and Rate Limiting

Authentication relies on asymmetric JSON Web Tokens (JWT) signed via RS256 [12]. Access tokens are short-lived (15 minutes) and delivered via HTTP-only, SameSite=Strict secure cookies, mitigating Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) token exfiltration. Session continuity is maintained through rotating refresh tokens stored with cryptographically secure salts. To protect against brute-force attacks and denial-of-service, an in-memory token bucket rate limiter restricts API calls to 100 requests per minute per IP address.

#### C. Input Sanitization and Injection Defense

The platform enforces a zero-trust boundary pipeline. Incoming payloads must conform strictly to Zod schemas compiled from the OpenAPI contract, preventing prototype pollution and parameter injection. Text inputs across chat messages and organizer announcements are sanitized using DOMPurify before DOM insertion to eliminate stored and reflected XSS.

#### D. Content Moderation and Abuse Reporting

An asynchronous reporting pipeline allows athletes to report inappropriate behavior, toxic chat messages, or organizer no-shows. When an organizer receives three verified flags within 30 days, their account is placed in probationary status pending administrative review, and their event creation privileges are temporarily throttled.

#### E. Ethical Oversight and Data Minimization

This study was conducted in strict adherence to data protection standards. All benchmarking traces utilized synthetic athlete profiles; municipal sports facility coordinates represent publicly accessible public park spaces, and no personally identifiable information (PII) was harvested or retained.

## VII. DISCUSSION, SCALABILITY & THREATS TO VALIDITY

#### A. Answering Research Questions

- **$RQ_1$  (Contract Conformance):** The OpenAPI 3.1 + Zod pipeline eliminated runtime schema drift completely, resulting in 0 serialization failures across 140 automated assertions.
- **$RQ_2$  (Geospatial Efficiency):** The dual-stage Cartesian B-Tree pre-filter delivered 28.4 ms query latency over  $M = 2,500$  fixtures, an  $8.8\times$  improvement over undexed scans at zero recurring API cost.
- **$RQ_3$  (Deterministic Allocation):** The waitlist state machine operated in 43.2 ms, mathematically proving and empirically verifying overbooking invariance ( $P(|A| > C) = 0$ ).
- **$RQ_4$  (Real-Time WebSockets):** Native WebSocket multiplexing achieved 14.6 ms broadcast delays, demonstrating a  $6.8\times$  latency reduction over HTTP short-polling.
- **$RQ_5$  (Reputation Governance):** Attendance-gated verification achieved 100% Sybil review rejection without false positives.

### B. Architectural Scalability & Distributed Pub/Sub

In its reference implementation, `SocketHub` operates as an in-memory `WebSocket` multiplexer supporting up to 5,000 active concurrent connections per single node. For multi-node cluster deployments, the state machine can be horizontally scaled by attaching a Redis Pub/Sub backplane adapter to distribute socket events across clustered instances without modifying client-facing interfaces.

### C. Threats to Validity

- **Internal Validity:** Network latencies were evaluated in a controlled testbed environment; cellular radio handover and carrier latency jitter may introduce variance in mobile field conditions, though protocol framing savings remain constant.
- **Construct Validity:** Concurrency benchmarks employed synthetic Poisson arrival generators modeling peak registration bursts.
- **External Validity:** Geospatial facility ground truth was validated in Peshawar, Pakistan; however, coordinate mathematics and OSM tile coverage apply universally worldwide.

## VIII. CONCLUSION & FUTURE ROADMAP

This paper presented **Live Arena**, an open-source, contract-first architecture engineered for scalable hyper-local sports event discovery, real-time matchmaking, and automated roster governance. By uniting an OpenAPI 3.1 single source of truth, an OpenStreetMap/Haversine geospatial pipeline, a deterministic FIFO waitlist state machine, and a native `WebSocket` streaming hub, Live Arena resolves the longstanding coordination friction, commercial court lock-in, and schema drift inherent in existing platforms. Extensive empirical benchmarks confirm sub-30 ms spatial queries, sub-15 ms message broadcasts, 340 req/s peak throughput, and 100% Sybil review rejection.

Future enhancements include incorporating an automated round-robin tournament bracket generator, Stripe Connect escrow split-payments for court rentals, and cross-platform native mobile clients built on React Native.

### ARTIFACT AVAILABILITY

The complete source code, OpenAPI 3.1 specification, Docker Compose orchestration files, synthetic trace generators, and benchmarking harnesses are publicly available under the open-source MIT License at:

<https://github.com/muhammadmaaz-2k5/LiveArena>

A permanent archival snapshot is indexed with Zenodo DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.14028912.

### AUTHOR BIOGRAPHIES

**Muhammad Maaz** received the B.S. degree in Computer Science from the University of Engineering and Technology (UET), Peshawar, Pakistan. He is a Systems Architect and

Software Engineer specializing in distributed web computing, contract-first API architectures, and real-time streaming systems. His research interests include event-based social computing, low-latency stateful microservices, and database systems engineering.

**Dr. Zakira Inayat** received the Ph.D. degree in Computer Science from the University of Malaya, Malaysia. She is currently an Assistant Professor in the Department of Computer Science at the University of Engineering and Technology (UET), Peshawar, Pakistan. Her research interests include cybersecurity, intrusion detection and mitigation systems, cloud computing security, and distributed networked systems. She has authored numerous peer-reviewed publications in international journals and conferences.

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